

HackWithSeattle — Official Problem Statement

Theme: Building Intelligent, Conversational AI Applications with RocketRide and Photon

The future of AI isn't just smart — it's connected. AI that reasons powerfully and lives where people already are: in their chats, their workflows, and their daily lives. This hackathon challenges you to combine the strengths of RocketRide and Photon to build intelligent, real-world applications that people would actually use.

Core Challenge

Design and build an innovative application that:

- Uses **RocketRide** to build and orchestrate AI pipelines directly in your development environment.
- Integrates **Photon** to deploy your AI agents across real messaging platforms including iMessage, WhatsApp, Telegram, Slack, Discord, SMS/RCS, and more.
- Demonstrates how AI pipelines + conversational interfaces can unlock new experiences, automate real problems, or delight real users.

Mandatory Requirements

Every project **MUST** adhere to the following:

- **RocketRide Usage:** Use RocketRide for at least one core AI pipeline or workflow.
- **Photon Integration:** Use Photon's Spectrum framework to connect your agent to at least one messaging platform.
- **Deep Integration:** Both technologies must be deeply integrated into the core product experience. Superficial usage (e.g., a pipeline that never talks to users, or a bot with no real AI logic) will lead to disqualification.
- **Flexibility:** Additional tools, APIs, and frameworks are welcome and encouraged.

Suggested Problem Tracks

Winning ideas will force meaningful integration of both RocketRide and Photon — not just surface-level use.

Track	Problem	Solution Summary
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1. Personal AI Chief of Staff	Managing tasks across too many apps.	RocketRide: Processes tasks and context. Photon: Delivers briefings via WhatsApp/iMessage.
2. Healthcare Triage Assistant	Difficulty accessing urgent care guidance.	RocketRide: Clinical reasoning for symptoms. Photon: SMS/WhatsApp bot for patient routing.
3. AI Tutor in Your Pocket	Students need 24/7 support.	RocketRide: Adaptive tutoring logic. Photon: Discord/Telegram quiz and progress tracking.
4. Hyper-Personal Shopper	Overwhelming online choices.	RocketRide: Product comparison pipeline. Photon: iMessage agent that recommends and compares.
5. AI Recruiting Screener	High volume of applications for teams.	RocketRide: Resume scoring pipeline. Photon: Slack bot for automatic interview scheduling.
6. Real-Time Crisis Alerting	Safety info is scattered and slow.	RocketRide: Actionable alert generation. Photon: Personalized safety updates via SMS/RCS.
7. Neighborhood Concierge	Finding local events in Seattle.	RocketRide: Local recommendation pipeline. Photon: WhatsApp/SMS bot for daily PNW suggestions.
8. Async Team Intelligence	Remote teams lose context in threads.	RocketRide: Summarizes discussions/blockers. Photon: Slack/Discord bot for async standups.

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9. Mental Wellness Check-In	Inconsistent mental health support.	RocketRide: Mood tracking and recommendations. Photon: Gentle daily iMessage check-ins.
10. Startup Co-Pilot	Founders need structured guidance.	RocketRide: Business model analysis/synthesis. Photon: Slack/WhatsApp on-demand founder expert.
11. Open Innovation	Identifying and synthesizing open-source projects or cited research relevant to a user's development challenge.	RocketRide: Pipeline that executes deep research and synthesizes findings into actionable next steps. Photon: Slack or Discord bot that responds to a developer's query with a cited research report.

Photon Prize

Objective: Build agents with the best conversational interface using Photon's Spectrum.

How to Qualify: Your project must integrate with iMessage via the Spectrum framework.

Resources:

- **Sign-Up:** Go to the dashboard (<https://app.photon.codes/sign-in>), sign up, and use the promo code **HACKWITHPHOTON** for a free Pro subscription.
- **iMessage Integration:** Connect your agent to iMessage through the dashboard.
- **Support:** We have our support channel on Discord (<https://discord.gg/bwMQ2dRGUW>) for more guidance.
- **Website + Dashboard:** <https://photon.codes/spectrum>
- **Docs:** <https://docs.photon.codes/>

Prize: Two winners (Best Photon Interfaces x 2) will each receive 1 month of Photon line, totaling a value of \$500.

Timeline

The event takes place on May 21, 2026 in Seattle.

Phase	Duration
On-site Build	8 Hours

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Extended Development	2–3 Additional Days
Final Submission & Demos	May 23, 2026

Evaluation Criteria

Projects will be judged based on:

- **Effective use of RocketRide:** Pipeline depth, logic, and intelligence.
- **Effective use of Photon:** Real messaging integration and user experience.
- **Innovation and originality:** Solving problems that actually matter.
- **Technical complexity:** Non-trivial integration of both platforms.
- **Real-world impact:** Practicality and usability for real users.
- **Demo quality:** Presentation and vision.

Deliverables

Each team must submit:

1. **Working prototype:** A live or local demo.
2. **Source code:** A repository link.
3. **Project description:** Detailing the problem solved, RocketRide pipeline usage, and Photon connectivity.
4. **Optional:** Pitch deck or demo video.

Final Note

HackWithSeattle is about more than shipping features, it's about reimagining how AI agents can be both powerful and personal. Combine the pipeline intelligence of RocketRide with the conversational reach of Photon to create something people would actually love to use.